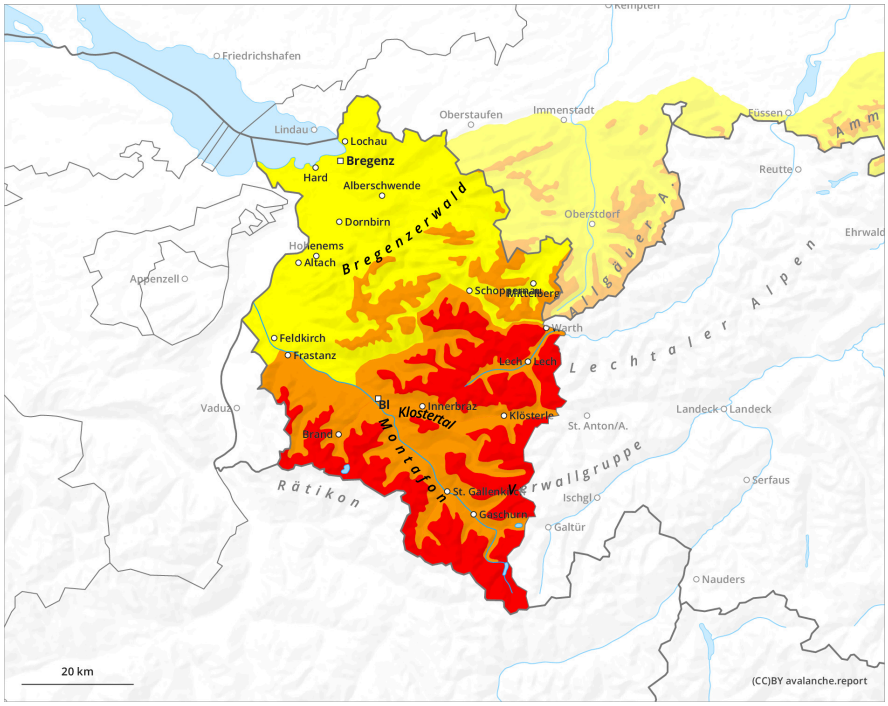
Wednesday 18 February 2026

Updated 18 Feb 2026, 09:07:00
Valid from 17 Feb 2026, 17:00:00 until 18 Feb 2026, 17:00:00
Written by Andreas Pecl

Lots of fresh snow and stormy winds, regionally high avalanche danger



1	2	3	4	5
low	moderate	considerable	high	very high

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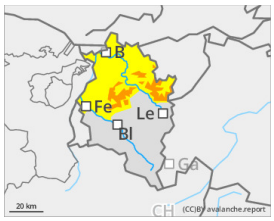
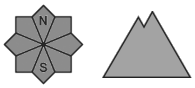
Danger Level 3 - Considerable

Treeline

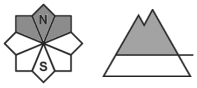
Tendency: Constant avalanche danger
on Thursday 19 February 2026



Wind slab



Persistent weak layer



1800m

Considerable avalanche danger at high altitudes.

Lots of fresh snow and drifts are prone to triggering. Avalanches can easily be triggered by one single winter sports enthusiast or be triggered naturally. Exposed areas can be placed at risk. Danger zones occur on steep slopes near to and distant from ridgelines, behind drops in the landscape and in wind-loaded gullies and bowls. Frequency and spread of avalanche prone locations increase with ascending altitude. Whumpf noises and fractures which appear when treading upon the snowpack, as well as freshly released avalanches are alarm signals. Activities in outlying terrain demand cautious assessment of the terrain and careful evaluation of the dangers. The inexperienced should not leave secured ski runs.

Snowpack

The large amounts of fresh fallen snow are continually being transported, new snowdrift accumulations are being generated. Fresh snow and drifts frequently lie deposited on graupel, in wind-protected terrain also atop surface hoar or on thin, trigger-sensitive melt-freeze layers. Also older snowdrifts and the weak snowpack are being blanketed by fresh snowfall.

Weather

Precipitation will taper off during the nocturnal hours. On Wednesday, light-to-moderate snowfall will once again set in towards midday. The snowfall level is expected to ascend to nearly 1200m. Temperature at 2000m: -9 to -2 degrees; at 3000m: -14 to -7 degrees. Brisk to strong velocity westerly winds at high altitudes, gusts reaching storm strength.

Tendency

Initially, no significant change anticipated. For winter sports enthusiasts the situation remains treacherous.